MANH-CUONG PHAN

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ORCID | ACL Anthology | Google Scholar

AI/NLP Researcher

OBJECTIVE

A Computer Science engineering graduate with a strong research foundation in Artificial Intelligence and Natural Language Processing, evidenced by publications in top-tier venues (e.g., ACL, EMNLP, PACLIC). Seeking an AI Researcher or Applied Scientist position to leverage expertise in Large Language Models (LLMs), multi-agent systems, and cognition-aware AI. Eager to drive technological innovation, bridge the gap between academic research and real-world applications, and develop scalable AI solutions that deliver impactful business value.

EDUCATION

- **Hung Yen University of Technology and Education** *Sep 2022 – Jul 2026*
  Bachelor of Engineering in Computer Science Vietnam
  - **Cumulative GPA:** 3.9/4.0 (Classification: Excellent)
  - **English Proficiency:** TOEIC 735
  - **Graduation:** July 2026
  - **Graduation Thesis:** *Research on Multi-Agent Systems Using LLMs with Refinement Loops for Cognitive Reframing*
  - **Relevant Coursework:** Natural Language Processing, Deep Learning, Machine Learning, Big Data Processing.

PUBLICATIONS

C=CONFERENCE, J=JOURNAL

[C.1] **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Huu-Loi Le, Thi-Ngoc-Phuong Nguyen, Duong-Hieu Le, Dinh-Phuc Pham, Hajime Hotta, Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2026). **Diving into the OCEAN: Coarse-to-Fine Evidence Validation for Zero-Shot Big Five Inference**. Under review at ACL ARR 2026.

[C.2] **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Thi-Ngoc-Phuong Nguyen, Huu-Loi Le, Huy-The Vu, Hajime Hotta, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2025). **From Span Extraction to Classification: A Multi-step Framework for Cognitive Distortion Analysis**. In *Proceedings of the 39th Pacific Asia Conference on Language, Information and Computation, pages 384–393, Hanoi, Vietnam. Association for Computational Linguistics.*.

[C.3] Minh-Tien Nguyen, Huu-Loi Le, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Duong-Hieu Le, Dinh-Phuc Pham, Van-Quyet Nguyen, Hajime Hotta. **Reframe to Retrieve: Cognition-aware RAG with Projections Inspired by Appraisal and CBT for Conversational Mental Health Support**. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2026* (accepted).

[C.4] Huu-Loi Le, Minh-Tien Nguyen, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Duong-Hieu Le, Dinh-Phuc Pham, Van-Quyet Nguyen, Van-Khanh Tran, Hajime Hotta. (2026). **CARE: Cognitive Appraisal-gated Reasoning for Multimodal Emotion Recognition in Conversations**. Under review at ACL ARR 2026.

[C.5] Minh-Tien Nguyen, Huu-Loi Le, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, and Hajime Hotta. (2026). **CMTD: Cognitive Modeling with Traits and Distortions for Multimodal Emotion Recognition in Conversations**. In *Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2026, pages 839–854, San Diego, California, United States. Association for Computational Linguistics.*.

[C.6] Thi-Ngoc-Phuong Nguyen, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Binh Le, Huu-Loi Le, Hajime Hotta and Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2026). **MindReframe: A Psychologically Grounded Cognitive Reframing Framework for Mental Health Support**. In *The 26th IEEE International Conference on Advanced Learning Technologies* (to be appeared).

[J.7] Minh-Tien Nguyen, Huu-Loi Le, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Van-Quyet Nguyen, HAJIME HOTTA. (2026). **Cognitive Distortion Modeling for Social Intelligence in Human-AI Conversational Systems**. In *IEEE Transactions on Computational Social Systems* (Under review).

[C.8] Hajime Hotta, Huu-Loi Le, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2025). **Metamo: Empowering Large Language Models with Psychological Distortion Detection for Cognition-aware Coaching**. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing: System Demonstrations, pages 862–872, Suzhou, China. Association for Computational Linguistics.*.

[C.9] Truong-Phuc Nguyen, Quy-Nhan Nguyen, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Chi-Hai Cao, Trinh-Hoai-An Duong, Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2025). **UTEHY-NLU@ ALQAC 2025: Dynamic Weighted Ensemble and Adaptive Reasoning for Vietnamese Legal Text Processing**. In *2025 17th International Conference on Knowledge and System Engineering (KSE), Da Lat, Vietnam, 2025, pp. 1-5, doi: 10.1109/KSE68178.2025.11309584*.

[C.10] Huu-Loi Le, **Manh-Cuong Phan**, Hajime Hotta, and Minh-Tien Nguyen. (2025). **Multimodal Emotion Recognition in Conversations with Distortion Analysis**. In *ACII 2025 Workshop on Multilingual and Multimodal Affective Computing (MMAC)* (accepted).

Skills

- **Programming & Scripting:** Python, SQL, Bash/Shell Scripting
- **AI & Machine Learning:** Natural Language Processing (NLP), Large Language Models (LLMs), Multi-agent Systems, Prompt Engineering, Affective Computing
- **DevOps & Version Control:** Linux (Ubuntu), Docker, Git
- **Academic & Formatting Tools:** LaTeX

Experience

- **Natural Language Understanding Lab (Alpha-Lab) [🌐]** *Mar 2024 – Present*
  Graduate Researcher & Mentor Hung Yen, Vietnam
  - Engineered LLM-based multi-agent systems grounded in psychological theories for diverse tasks, including Emotion Recognition in Conversations (ERC), Cognitive Reframing (CR), Cognitive-Aware RAG under the supervision of Prof. Minh-Tien Nguyen.
  - Co-authored multiple papers at top-tier venues (ACL, EMNLP, PACLIC) and mentored junior members in NLP and model implementation.

- **AI Academy Vietnam [🌐]** *June 2025 – Jul 2026*
  NLP Researcher/Engineer Hanoi, Vietnam
  - Developed core NLP solutions (text classification, information extraction) using Transformer architectures for national digital transformation projects.
  - Engineered scalable machine learning workflows and data pipelines utilizing Docker, Kafka, and Spark to ensure high availability.

- **Feng Chia University [🌐]** *Jul 2026 – Present*
  AI/ML Research Intern (TEEP) Taichung, Taiwan
  - Selected for the MOE-funded Taiwan Experience Education Program (TEEP) to research "AI, LLM, Precision Medicine".
  - Developed AI/ML applications within the Department of Information Engineering and Computer Science, fostering cross-institutional academic exchange.

Projects & Leadership Experience

- **MindReframe: AI-powered Cognitive Reframing System** (Technical Lead) *Dec 2025 – June 2026*
  Tools: LLMs, Multi-agent Frameworks, Hugging Face [🌐]
  - Engineered and deployed an interactive LLM-based multi-agent web app to dynamically identify and reframe cognitive distortions.
  - Bridged psychological principles with NLP techniques by incorporating clinical feedback, successfully fulfilling the core requirements for the graduation thesis.

- **PoseAI: Interactive Mental Health Therapy Robot** (Technical Lead) *Feb 2026 – May 2026*
  Tools: Python, LLMs, Edge Computing, IoT/ESP32 [▶]
  - Engineered and deployed PoseAI, a smart therapy robot designed to act as a daily stress-relief companion.
  - Integrated empathetic AI to help users balance their emotions, bridging software algorithms with physical hardware for practical mental health support.

Honors and Awards

- **Certificate of Presentation (First Author)** *Dec 2025*
  The 39th Pacific Asia Conference on Language, Information and Computation (PACLIC 39) [🌐]
  - Recognized for successfully presenting the research paper "From Span Extraction to Classification: A Multi-step Framework for Cognitive Distortion Analysis".

- **Certificate of Recognition/Presentation** *Nov 2025*
  International Conference on Knowledge and Systems Engineering (KSE) [🌐]
  - Awarded for academic contribution and presentation at the KSE conference.

- **Certificate of Participation** *Jul 2025*
  2025 Language and Culture Camp – Ming Chi University of Technology (Taiwan) [🌐]
  - Participated in the cultural exchange and language program organized by the Office of International Affairs.

References

1. Assoc. Prof. Minh-Tien Nguyen, Ph.D.
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Hung Yen University of Technology and Education
Email: tiennm@utehy.edu.vn
Relationship: Research Advisor.

2. Dr. Van-Quyet Nguyen, Ph.D.
Head of Software Engineering Department, Faculty of IT
Hung Yen University of Technology and Education
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Relationship: Research Collaborator.